

Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/kartik-sahni
(LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Due Diligence
Mergers & Acquisitions (M&A)
Startups

Publications

Our Investment Thesis | Next
Frontiers for the Next Half Billion
Our Grantmaking Thesis | Next
Frontiers for the Next Half Billion
Building India's Innovation Economy:
Catalyzing Private R&D Activity
Through the ANRF

Kartik Sahni

MBA/MPP candidate at Harvard
Boston, Massachusetts, United States

Summary

MBA from Harvard Business School and MPP from Harvard Kennedy School (joint degree), with experience across catalytic finance (climate & development finance, impact investments), venture capital, strategy, organization management, and public policy.

My work lies intersection of finance, strategy and policy. I've worked with purpose-driven organizations across the private, public and social sectors addressing some of the most pressing global challenges— climate change, education, innovation and inclusive growth. I've had the opportunity to help build and shape institutions through strategy design, implementation, capital mobilization, and cross-sector collaboration.

I focus on driving capital towards underinvested areas and translating complex challenges into actionable strategies and meaningful results—through clear thinking, strong execution, and collaboration across sectors.

Experience

Harvard's Belfer Center
Climate Adaptation Finance
June 2025 - Present (7 months)
Boston, Massachusetts, United States

Exploring market and policy interventions to increase investments in climate adaptation and resilience. Faculty: Prof. Akash Deep, Prof. Henry Lee.

Self-employed
Independent Consultant & Advisor - Foundations, Non-Profits
July 2025 - Present (6 months)
United States

- Independently advise global foundations and non-profits on organization strategy, fundraising, organizational growth, portfolio construction, impact measurement and monitoring.
- Develop investment strategies and optimize portfolio operations across sectors including climate, education, economic mobility, humanitarian assistance.
- Collaborate with stakeholders to enhance social impact initiatives, ensuring alignment with mission-driven goals.

IFC - International Finance Corporation

Intern (South-South Investments)

June 2024 - August 2024 (3 months)

Delhi, India

South-South cross-border investments (climate/EV investments, blended finance transactions).

Harvard Kennedy School

Assistant Podcast Producer & RA, Reimagining the Economy Project

October 2022 - April 2024 (1 year 7 months)

Cambridge, Massachusetts, United States

The Reimagining the Economy project at Harvard Kennedy School produces multidisciplinary scholarship to reshape narratives about how we achieve inclusive prosperity. Faculty co-Directors Profs. Dani Rodrik and Gordon Hanson.

Assistant Producer, "Policy Works" Podcast. Policy Works investigates the institutions, actors, and systems through which economic development policies are implemented.

Varaha

Summer Associate (Carbon Projects, Carbon Markets)

May 2023 - August 2023 (4 months)

Gurugram, Haryana, India

Climate Finance (project finance, voluntary carbon markets) and Strategic Partnerships.

Varaha is a project developer of nature-based solutions for CO2 avoidance & permanent removal - including regenerative agriculture, agroforestry, mangrove and biochar projects that promote climate adaptation, biodiversity,

water conservation and increased income for more than 100,000 smallholder land stewards.

Omidyar Network

Chief of Staff

November 2020 - August 2022 (1 year 10 months)

Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

Chief of Staff, Omidyar Network India - impact investment firm focused on meaningfully impacting the lives of India's "Next Half Billion", making venture capital and philanthropic investments. Omidyar Network India is part of The Omidyar Group, a diverse collection of companies, organizations and initiatives, supported by philanthropists Pam and Pierre Omidyar, founder of eBay.

Worked with Managing Partner on overall strategic and operational priorities, including investment management, stakeholder relations, organization growth and strategic initiatives.

Kaizenvest

Private Equity & Strategy Intern

July 2020 - October 2020 (4 months)

Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

Supported Managing Partners on conceptualising and articulating Kaizen's impact measurement and management strategy for its education-focused growth equity portfolio.

EY-Parthenon

Strategy Consultant (Emerging Markets Education)

July 2016 - June 2020 (4 years)

Mumbai

Advised the world's largest private education operators and investors on strategy, due diligence and M&A. Advised non-profit & public sector clients on designing and implementing large-scale education programs.

On-ground experience: 15+ countries across India, APAC, Middle East, Africa, Latin America.

Segments covered: EdTech, K-12, Higher Ed, Early Childhood Education, Test Prep

The Education Alliance

CEO's Office (Secondment)

September 2019 - December 2019 (4 months)

Co-created a new systems transformation approach that TEA is executing in partnership with several Indian state governments to fix underlying 'foundational infrastructure' of public K-12 systems.

JSW

Strategy Intern

May 2015 - July 2015 (3 months)

Aditya Birla Group

Intern

May 2014 - July 2014 (3 months)

Education

Harvard Business School

Master of Business Administration - MBA · (2022 - 2025)

Harvard Kennedy School

Master's degree, Public Policy · (2022 - 2025)

St. Stephen's College

Bachelor of Arts (with Honours), Economics

St.Columba's School, New Delhi